

Katrina Engelsted

Boulder, Colorado, USA

katrina@engelsted.co
774.239.8699
linkedin.com/in/katrinae

September 9, 2026

The Wilderness Society Hiring Team

The Wilderness Society

RE: DATA AND ANALYTICS DIRECTOR (1-YEAR TERM)

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Data and Analytics Director role because I want the next chapter of my career to put my technical skills toward something I genuinely care about: protecting the places and communities that make this country special.

The Wilderness Society feels like a particularly strong fit. My career has consistently lived at the intersection of technology, data, and environmental work—from geospatial projects for the National Park Service and disaster-response mapping with the Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team, to building CRM and marketing-technology systems, working with customer data platforms, and more recently applying AI and modern data architecture to operational problems. I'm at my best when I'm taking a messy system or dataset, figuring out how the pieces should fit together, and turning it into something people can actually use to make better decisions.

I bring hands-on experience across much of the technical foundation this role calls for. At Zayo, I owned Salesforce CRM and marketing-automation workflows, using data to support segmentation, lead scoring, and campaign performance. At Teren, I built marketing-technology infrastructure around audience and operational data. At Lytics, I worked inside an enterprise customer data platform, leading client implementations and using BigQuery, Python, and APIs to validate data and translate business requirements into working systems. I've also built a Snowflake-based data warehouse and pipelines and, more recently, have been building production AI-agent workflows and a governed semantic layer on top of dbt. That combination of CRM, data engineering, analytics, and applied AI is where I see a particularly strong connection to what TWS is building.

My GIS background adds another dimension that I believe would be especially useful to The Wilderness Society. I hold a BA in Geography (GIS), with Honors and a spatial-statistics thesis, and spent several years working on mapping and data projects connected to public lands. I'm comfortable thinking about data not just as rows in a database, but geographically—how information connects people, places, campaigns, infrastructure, and outcomes. The opportunity to bring that perspective to geographic reporting, advocacy analytics, and the broader public-lands mission is exciting to me.

I'm also drawn to the strategic nature of this position. The challenge isn't simply implementing another tool or adding AI because it is available. It is creating a reliable data foundation, establishing governance people will actually follow, and then finding the places where automation and AI can meaningfully extend a small team's capacity without compromising privacy, accuracy, or judgment. That is the kind of technical problem I enjoy: understand the system, build the right infrastructure, make it usable, and help the organization adopt it.

What ultimately motivates me is the chance to use these skills in service of a mission with real stakes. I've spent much of my career helping organizations understand their customers and operate more effectively. I'd now like to apply that same problem-solving ability to an organization working to protect public lands, wildlife, clean water, and the future of those places.

I would welcome the opportunity to talk about how my background in CRM, data infrastructure, GIS, and applied AI could help The Wilderness Society build a stronger data foundation and turn that foundation into better decisions and greater impact.

Thank you for your consideration.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO